GRAIN DUST COLLECTOR — PROJECT FORM

Title:

SMART GRAIN DUST COLLECTOR

“Clean Air – Safe Grain – Healthy Farmers”

Problem:

During grain cleaning, loading, unloading and transportation, fine grain dust becomes airborne. It can affect workers' breathing, reduce cleanliness and create safety risks.

Solution:

Our model uses a **small suction fan + pipe + cyclone/filter chamber + dust collection container**. The fan pulls dusty air into the chamber. Heavier particles fall into the collection box, while the filter traps finer dust before cleaner air leaves the system.

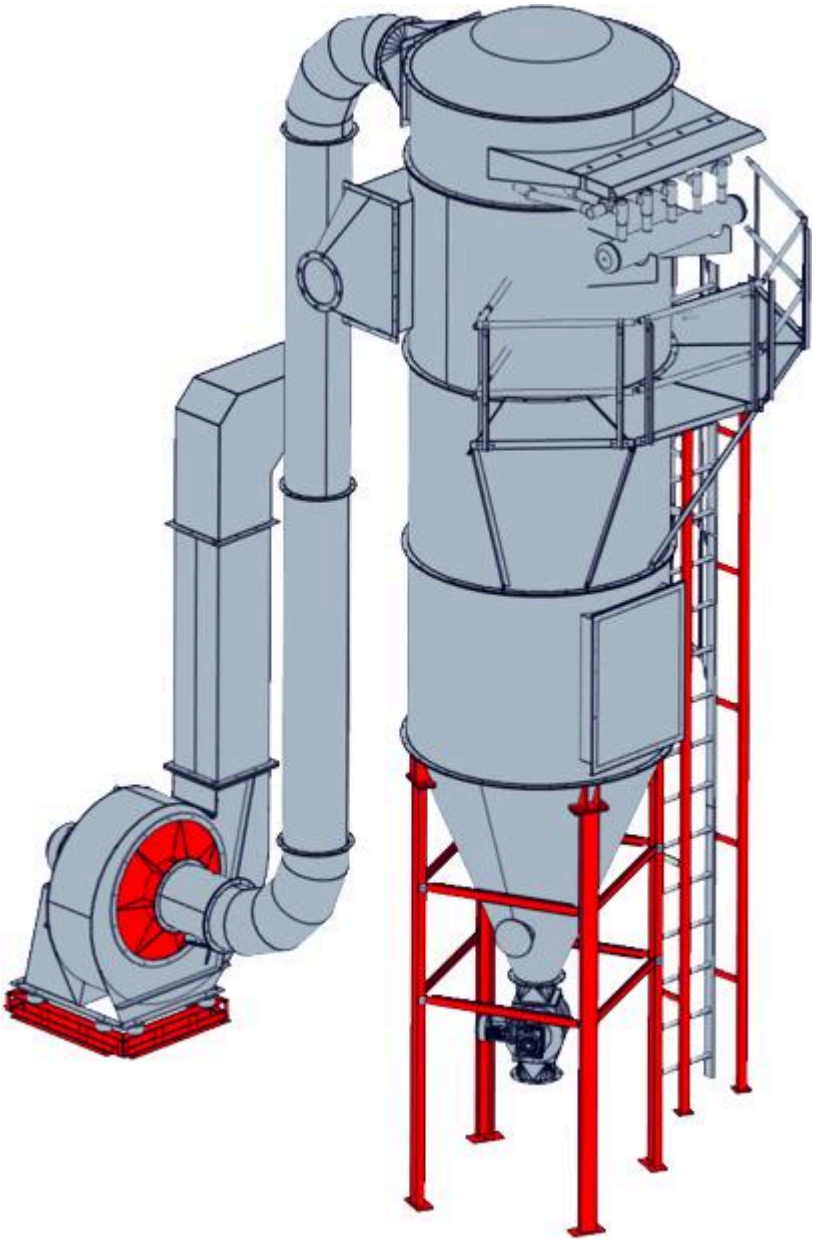
Main Parts:

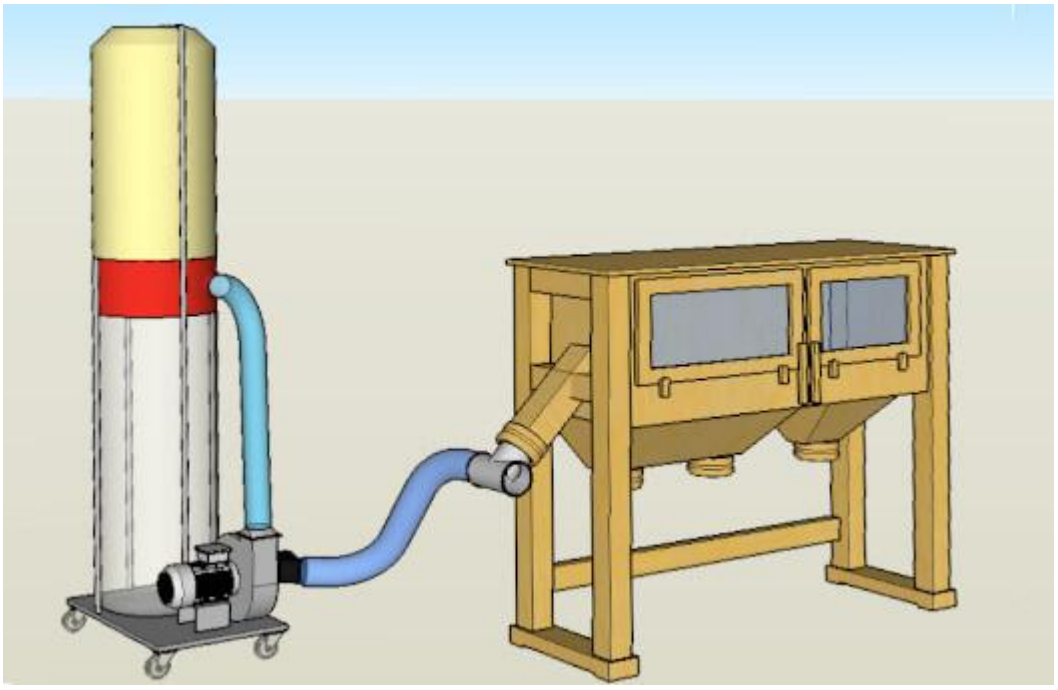
- Small DC fan/blower
- PVC pipe
- Plastic bottle/container for cyclone chamber
- Cloth/cotton filter
- Dust collection box
- Cardboard/foam-board base
- Connecting wires
- Battery
- Switch
- Grain/rice for demonstration

Working:

`GRAIN → DUSTY AIR → SUCTION FAN → CYCLONE/SEPARATOR → FILTER → CLEANER AIR`







4

⭐ Model Explanation

1. Dust generation:

When grain is poured or transferred, small dust particles become airborne.

2. Suction:

A DC fan creates suction and pulls the dusty air through the pipe.

3. Separation:

Inside the cyclone-shaped chamber, the air rotates. Larger/heavier particles move downward into the collection container.

4. Filtration:

The remaining fine dust passes through a cloth/filter.

5. Clean-air outlet:

Cleaner air comes out through the outlet.

This is based on the principle of cyclone separation and filtration used in real grain-dust systems.

4. How the Model Works

Step 1 — Grain handling

Put rice/wheat/millet into the demonstration hopper.

When the grain falls, some fine dust becomes airborne.

Step 2 — Dust suction

A small **DC blower/fan** creates negative pressure.

It pulls the dusty air into the pipe.

Step 3 — Cyclone chamber

The dusty air enters the chamber tangentially and starts rotating.

Because of centrifugal action, heavier particles move toward the wall and fall downward.

Step 4 — Dust collection

The separated particles fall into a **dust collection bottle/container**.

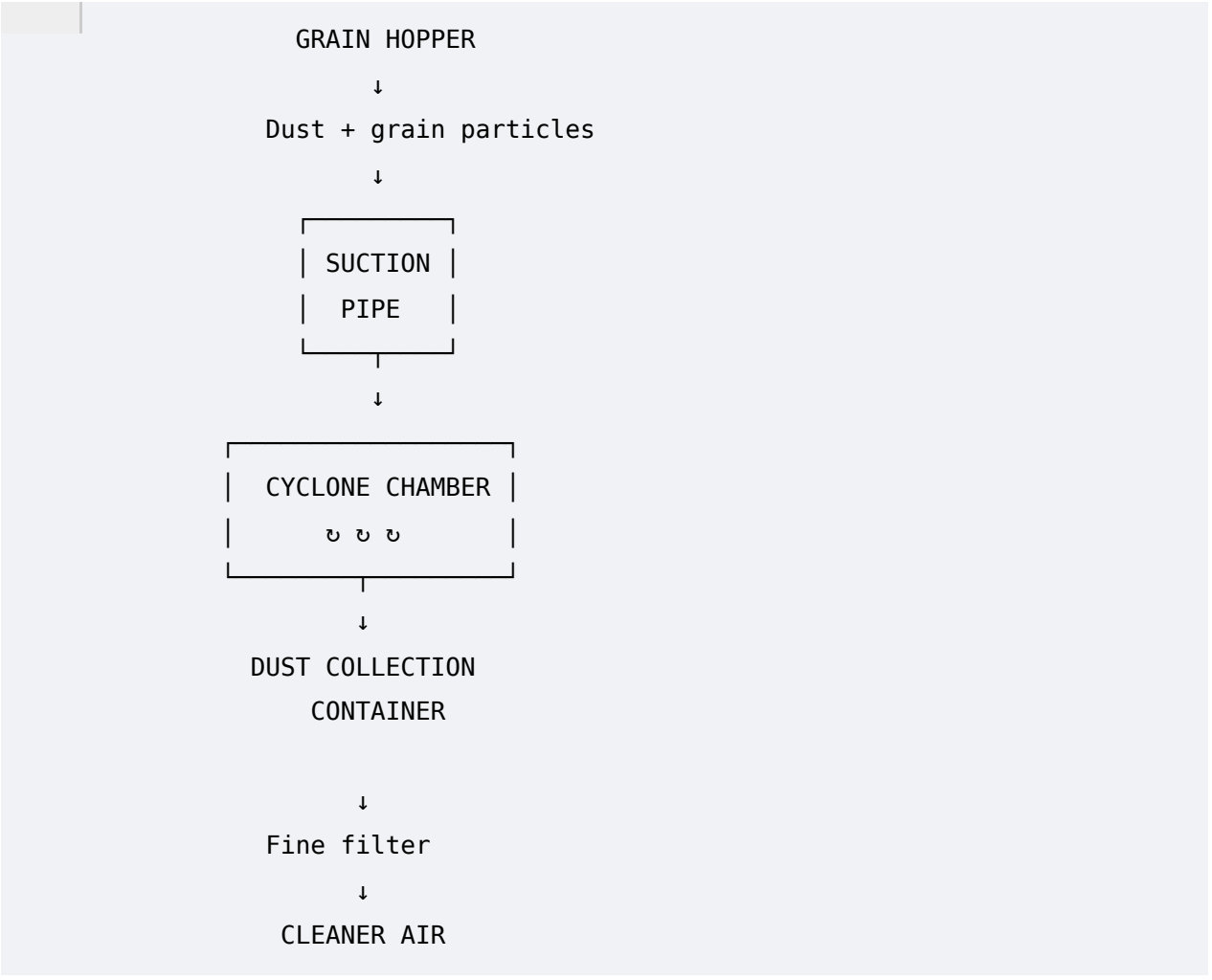
Step 5 — Fine filtration

The remaining air passes through a **cloth/filter layer** that catches smaller particles.

Step 6 — Cleaner air

The filtered air exits through the outlet.

Simple diagram:



🔬 5. Scientific Principles

Your project demonstrates several principles:

A. Suction / Airflow

The fan creates airflow that carries dust from the grain-processing area toward the collector.

B. Centrifugal separation

In the cyclone chamber, rotating airflow causes heavier particles to move outward and fall down.

C. Filtration

A filter physically traps fine particles while allowing air to pass.

D. Gravity

Separated particles fall into the collection container due to gravity.

🧰 6. Materials Required

Component	Purpose
Small DC blower/fan	Creates suction
PVC pipe/tube	Carries dusty air
Transparent plastic bottle	Cyclone chamber
Small container	Dust collection
Cotton/cloth filter	Fine dust filtration

Battery	Power source
Switch	ON/OFF control
Wires	Electrical connections
Cardboard/foam board	Model base
Funnel	Grain inlet
Rice/wheat/millet	Demonstration material

For a school prototype, you can use inexpensive recycled materials wherever possible.

💡 7. Make It More Innovative

If you are presenting this at a science exhibition, don't stop at a basic fan + filter.

Add these features:

⭐ Innovation 1 — Two-stage dust collection

Instead of sending everything directly to the filter:

Stage 1: Cyclone removes heavier particles

Stage 2: Fine filter catches smaller particles

This reduces the amount of dust reaching the filter.

⭐ Innovation 2 — Transparent chamber

Use a transparent bottle so judges can **see the dust rotating and settling**.

This makes the scientific principle visually understandable.

⭐ Innovation 3 — Dust-level indicator

Add a simple **LED indicator**:

- 🟢 Empty
- 🟡 Half full
- 🔴 Full

A sensor can detect when the collection container needs cleaning.

⭐ Innovation 4 — Automatic fan control

You could add a dust sensor so that:

Dust detected → Fan ON

Dust reduced → Fan speed decreases

That turns the project into a **Smart Grain Dust Collector**.

⭐ Innovation 5 — Dust recovery

The collected material can be examined to determine whether it is:

- useful grain particles,
- husk,
- bran,
- soil,
- or other contaminants.

This adds an interesting **waste-reduction/recovery** angle.

🧪 8. Experiments You Can Perform

This is especially important because a project becomes much stronger when you have **data**.

Experiment A — Before vs After

Measure the amount of visible dust:

Test	Without collector	With collector
Dust observed	High	Low

Air cleanliness	Low	Higher
Dust collected	—	Measurable

You can use the same quantity of grain for every test.

Experiment B — Different filters

Try:

1. Cotton
2. Cloth
3. Multiple-layer cloth

Record which one captures the most dust while still allowing good airflow.

Experiment C — Fan speed

Test:

- Low speed
- Medium speed
- High speed

Record the amount of dust captured.

Experiment D — Collection efficiency

You can calculate:

Collection efficiency (%)

$$\text{Efficiency} = \frac{\text{Dust captured}}{\text{Total dust generated}} \times 100$$

For a school prototype, clearly label your result as **model/test efficiency**, not industrial performance.

You can actually fill this during your experiment:

Trial	**Grain quantity**	**Fan speed**	**Dust collected**	**Filter condition**

1	100 g	Low	___ g	Clean
2	100 g	Medium	___ g	Slightly dusty
3	100 g	High	___ g	Dusty
4	200 g	Medium	___ g	Dusty

📊 9. Observation Table

This gives judges evidence that you **tested your idea rather than just making a model**.

🌱 10. Advantages

- Reduces airborne grain dust.
- Helps improve cleanliness around grain-processing areas.
- Demonstrates dust separation using simple materials.
- Can collect dust instead of allowing it to spread.
- Low-cost educational prototype.
- Can potentially be adapted for small grain-processing operations.
- Uses locally available/recycled materials.
- Can be upgraded with sensors and automatic control.

Dust collection is an established approach to controlling dust emissions in grain-handling environments.

⚠️ 11. Important Safety Point

For your **school model**, use a tiny quantity of clean grain and a low-voltage battery-powered fan.

Do **not** deliberately create a concentrated grain-dust cloud or try to demonstrate an explosion/fire. Grain dust can be combustible, and real industrial dust collectors require proper engineering and safety measures.

🏆 12. Strong Conclusion

“The Grain Dust Collector is a low-cost solution designed to capture dust generated during grain handling. By combining suction, cyclone separation, gravity and filtration, the system separates dust from the airflow and collects it instead of allowing it to spread into the surroundings. The prototype demonstrates how simple scientific principles can be used to address a real agricultural and occupational-safety problem.”

🎤 One-line explanation for judges

> **“Our model captures grain dust at its source, separates heavier particles using a cyclone, filters fine particles, and releases cleaner air.**

🎯 Advantages

- Reduces airborne grain dust
- Helps create a cleaner working environment
- Collects reusable grain particles
- Low-cost school prototype
- Can be adapted for rice mills and grain storage areas
- Demonstrates a real industrial problem with a simple working model

🏆 Conclusion

“The Smart Grain Dust Collector provides a simple and affordable way to demonstrate how grain dust can be captured at its source. By combining suction, cyclone separation and filtration, the model helps protect workers and improve cleanliness in grain-processing areas.”